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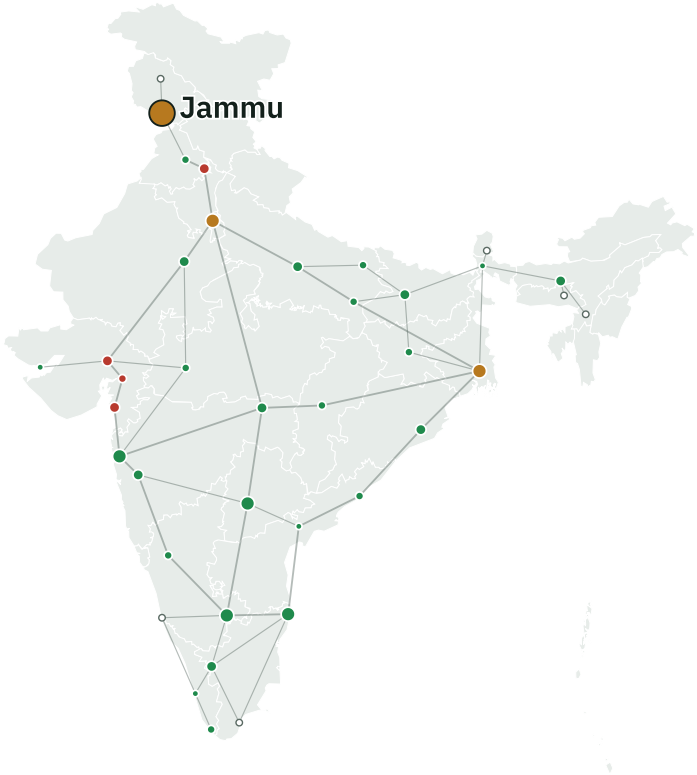
Chennai's customs brokers give MSC five days over empty-box charges

● NETWORK: AMBER

DIWALI WEEK · 2 DAYS SINCE DIWALI

For heads of logistics moving goods within, into or out of India, wherever they sit: what to move, hold or reroute this week.

Chennai's customs brokers have threatened to boycott MSC shipments unless the line changes how it collects empty-container charges by 15 November, one trade report says[1]. Jammu's largest wholesale grain market stays shut till Wednesday after a Diwali-night fire. Gujarat's holiday stretch starts today and runs to Saturday. This is the bulletin's last edition; the calls are scored at the end.



Map: DataMeet, CC BY 4.0

● GREEN normal for the week: busy, but plans hold
● AMBER something slows freight beyond a normal week
● RED freight largely stopped across a state, corridor or gateway

DATES THAT MATTER

- **Since Sun 1 Nov** Delhi turns away BS-IV and older vehicles at its borders[2]
- **Since Fri 6 Nov** Delhi-NCR on Stage III of GRAP, its pollution action plan[3]
- **Mon 9 – Wed 11 Nov** Kolkata curbs goods vehicles for the immersions
- **Until Thu 12 Nov** Pune's old-city markets take goods vehicles only at night
- **Tue 10 – Sat 14 Nov** Most Gujarat firms shut till Labh Pancham; I'd expect Mon 16 Nov to be the first full day
- **Sun 15 Nov** Chennai brokers' deadline to MSC

DELIVERY PROMISE BY REGION

North	West	South	East	Northeast	Central
+1*	+0	+0	+0	+0	+0
AMBER	GREEN	GREEN	GREEN	GREEN	GREEN

* Likely extra days on freight within the region this week, to Sun 15 Nov, on the places named, against a normal week.

Apart from the dates listed, this morning's search found nothing slowing freight on roads, railways or borders in the South, East, Central India or the Northeast.

Chennai's customs brokers threaten to boycott MSC cargo over empty-container charges

South, West · Container imports and exports through Chennai, Mundra and Nhava Sheva

GREEN · MEDIUM COST OF DELAY · MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

The Chennai Customs Brokers Association wants MSC to stop collecting empty-container charges through third-party depot vendors by 15 November, or it will boycott MSC shipments, a trade report says[1]. The same report says Maersk raised its charge for lifting empties at Mundra from 1 November, from $23 to $51 a 20-foot box and from $31 to $67 a 40-foot. Some lines at Nhava Sheva now let nominated yards collect such charges from shippers, it adds. I found no reply from MSC and no second report. Mind you, this is one trade paper's account of a threat.

- **Chennai port, MSC boxes** South · +0 days Nothing is held yet. If the boycott starts after 15 November, I'd expect MSC boxes handled by the association's members to wait at the yard until the importer finds another broker.
- **Mundra, Gujarat's biggest container port** West · +0 days This one costs money, not days. Every Maersk empty returned there now pays the higher charge at the depot, so I'd expect a box to be held at the gate only if the charge is unpaid.
- **Nhava Sheva, Mumbai's container port** West · +0 days Shippers there may start paying the yard directly, so I'd expect the cost to shift before any delay does. Cargo handlers are resisting it, so watch for the same fight there.

DECISIONS TO MAKE

For freight into and out of India

- If your Chennai boxes come on MSC, ask your broker this week whether it belongs to the association. Ask what it will do after 15 November; a box nobody will clear waits at the yard, my estimate.
- Add the higher empty-return charge to Maersk boxes through Mundra from the 1 November rate, and ask your line at Nhava Sheva whether charges have moved to its yards, my estimate.

A Diwali-night fire shuts Jammu's largest wholesale grain market till Wednesday

North · Jammu's Warehouse-Nehru Market, which trades foodgrains and edible oil

AMBER · MEDIUM COST OF DELAY · MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

Fire gutted shops at the Warehouse-Nehru Market on Diwali night: one report counts ten[4], another eight[5]. Traders shut the market on Monday and say it stays shut till Wednesday, in protest at the fire service's response[4], which the department disputes[6]. The market deals in foodgrains, edible oils and other essentials[5]. I found no report yet of shortages or of trucks turned back.

- **Jammu** North · +1 day With the market shut, I'd expect trucks bound for it to wait to unload and grain and oil loads to slip a day or more, with reopening on Thursday the earliest.

DECISIONS TO MAKE

For freight within India

- Hold grain and edible-oil loads for this market until traders confirm it has reopened, Thursday at the earliest; a truck sent before that is likely to wait, my estimate.

THE PEAK, SCORED

This is the last edition of the India Network Bulletin. The peak's one set of calls, made on 2 November, came out two right and one I could not check. Murasu crossed the coast where I said it would, and Delhi reached Stage II before the 9th. I never could read the railway's waiting lists for the 17th. Across the whole run I scored 15 calls: nine right, one partly right, two wrong and three I could not settle. The site and every edition stay up. Thank you for reading.

SOURCES

1. The Loadstar: Cargo boycott threat by Indian brokers over empty-box fee hikes, 9 Nov
2. ETV Bharat: Delhi turns away BS-IV vehicles for a second day, 2 Nov
3. Outlook: Delhi AQI after Diwali, thick smog chokes capital, 9 Nov
4. ThePrint (PTI): Fire-hit Warehouse-Nehru Market to remain closed till Wednesday, 9 Nov
5. Daily Excelsior: Political leaders, parties demand relief, probe into Warehouse fire incident, 10 Nov
6. Kashmir Thunder: Massive fire damages shops, godowns in Jammu Warehouse market, 10 Nov